

This creates a Git *branch dev* and switches to it. Make changes to the code as follows:

```
$ arc diff
```

This will submit the differences for review. You will need to make some entry in the *Test Plan* section of the text file associated with the review.

Once the review is approved, use the following command:

```
$ arc land
```

This will merge the changes in the *dev* branch with the master branch and push them to the upstream repository.

In case you get the error message that the master in the origin is checked out, it is a Git issue. You will need to check out an alternate branch in the project repo and run the ‘land’ option again.

The ‘land’ option will fail if the code review has not been approved. The process cannot prevent you from pushing the code upstream without approval. You could, for example, push your code upstream using the Git command directly.

Review process

Any submission of the code changes will be shown on the home page of Phabricator under ‘Waiting for review’. In case a reviewer has not mentioned this in the ‘arc diff’ request, you may edit the revision request and add a reviewer. Obviously, the reviewer cannot be the submitter!

Using the reviewer’s account, you may review the revision request. You will be shown the differences for each of the files that have been modified. The reviewers may give their

comments and add the action of approving the submission, requesting changes, or even resigning as the reviewer!

The application lets you focus on just the changes and makes it easy to complete the review.

Phabricator has the option to add repositories. The simplest option would be to add a repository which will follow the authoritative repository, as follows.

Choose the options *Create Repository* → *Create New Git Repository* and enter the details for the repository. Choose a call sign, like the capital letter R, for simplicity.

Activate the repository on the repository management page – *diffusion/R/manage*.

On the same page, choose the URIs option to add a new URI – *ssh://user@host/~repo/project*, with the I/O type ‘Observe:Copy from a Remote’.

You will need to supply the credentials, which will be the private key and contents of *.ssh/id_rsa*, for a passwordless ssh login.

The ability to access the repository contents during the review from the same interface can be convenient.

We have just touched on the basics of Phabricator. You will find many more functionalities in the tool, when you explore further.

Understanding and trying out one or more code review tools will be a valuable asset in any programmer’s repository of experience. **END** 

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The author has earned the right to do what interests him. You can find him online at <http://sethanil.com> and <http://sethanil.blogspot.com>.

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